

TEXT — WHAT YOU ALREADY DO

MORE COMPLEX

What You Can Make with Claude

faculty projects, ordered from familiar text toward unfamiliar code — and past it

The spine on the left runs from what you already do every day — **writing** — down toward things you may never have built before. Each row names a *kind* of thing you can make: quick examples on the left, one **unpacked** on the right — situation, inputs, operations, outputs, and the interface that fits (**CHAT** **COWORK** **CODE**). Start where you have expertise; climb down when you're ready. The axis continues on the back of this page — and runs off the bottom of it.

1 Structured Text & Documents

MOST FAMILIAR

EXAMPLES

- Email to a chair proposing a new course
- Grant Specific Aims page from a project description
- Committee report from raw meeting notes
- Recommendation letter from a CV and a prompt
- Conference abstract from a draft paper
- Syllabus skeleton from a reading list

UNPACKED

Meeting notes → a clean report for the dean

SITUATION	Messy notes from a faculty meeting; a structured report due tomorrow.
INPUTS	meeting-notes.md — your raw bullet points.
OPERATIONS	One prompt: "turn these into a report with a summary, decisions made, and action items with owners and dates."
OUTPUTS	report.md , or a polished .docx on request.
BEST FIT	CHAT COWORK CODE IF REPEATED MONTHLY

2 Reference Pages

static HTML

INTRO TO CODE

EXAMPLES

- A searchable glossary of course terms
- A one-page syllabus website
- A printable command/reference dashboard
- An illustrated lecture handout
- A course-policy FAQ page

UNPACKED

A glossary your students can search and copy from

SITUATION	One page holding every key term in your course, searchable, works offline.
INPUTS	glossary.md — terms and definitions.
OPERATIONS	"Build a single-file HTML page with a search box and click-to-copy, styled for comfortable reading."
OUTPUTS	glossary.html — one file you can email or host anywhere.
BEST FIT	CODE COWORK

3 Web Apps

Next.js

MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES

- A course website with interactive concept demos
- A reading-response collection app
- An interactive timeline of a period or movement
- A "build your own X" student exercise

UNPACKED

Course site for GENED 1049 East Asian Cinema

SITUATION	A site pairing a cinematography glossary with demos built on the films you actually teach.
INPUTS	Syllabus, <i>Rashomon</i> stills, glossary text.
OPERATIONS	Scaffold a Next.js app, build parametric demo components, deploy to Vercel.
OUTPUTS	A live site (gened-1049.vercel.app) you share by link.
BEST FIT	CODE

Turn over — the axis keeps descending: connected tools, visualizations, agentic systems, and the unmarked territory past the bottom edge.

...and further down the spine

connected tools, visualizations, agentic systems — and what's past the bottom edge

4 Bots & Connected ToolsMCP, Slack

TODAY'S TOPIC

EXAMPLES ■ Claude connected to Semantic Scholar for live literature search ■ An art-history lecture pulling live images from Harvard Art Museums ■ A Slack bot that answers from your course materials ■ An oral-exam practice bot ■ Claude connected to your Google Drive	UNPACKED
	Live literature search via the Semantic Scholar MCP
	SITUATION
	INPUTS
	OPERATIONS
	OUTPUTS
BEST FIT	

5 Data Visualizationsd3, three.js

EVEN MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES ■ A 2D semantic-embedding map of a text corpus ■ An interactive chart of course-evaluation trends ■ A 3D model of a molecule, artifact, or building ■ A network graph of citations or characters ■ An animated explainer for a hard concept	UNPACKED
	Calvino's Six Memos, by the numbers
	SITUATION
	INPUTS
	OPERATIONS
	OUTPUTS
BEST FIT	

6 Agentic Pipelines & Systems

MOST COMPLEX

EXAMPLES ■ Close-reading a whole corpus with parallel subagents ■ A reproducible coding pipeline for interview transcripts ■ An automated weekly research digest (scheduled) ■ A recommendation engine grounded in institutional data	UNPACKED
	Naming every writer cited across 538 Dylan songs
	SITUATION
	INPUTS
	OPERATIONS
	OUTPUTS
BEST FIT	

? The Gesamtkunstwerk

BEYOND THE MAP

Every category above ends in a file. This one doesn't. Somewhere past the bottom of the axis is the **total work** — beyond text, beyond code, out into media forms and the world: an installation that listens and answers; a seminar that generates its own archive as it runs; a dataset performed as sound; an instrument, a fabrication, a room. The project where the website, the handouts, the bots, and the physical space are one continuous thing.

Nobody has a worked example yet. The spine runs off the edge of the page here — this row is yours to invent.

The arc of the week in one page (well, two): every row is the same loop — inputs in a folder, an operation that transforms them, outputs you can hand to someone. What changes as you descend is only how much of the loop is code. Worked versions of nearly every row live in this repo's [examples/more-examples/](#).